

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Extracorporeal Photopheresis

110.4

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

110.4

Manual Section Title

Extracorporeal Photopheresis

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

12/19/2006

Ending Effective Date of this Version

04/30/2012

Implementation Date

04/02/2007

Description Information

Benefit Category

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Extracorporeal photopheresis is a medical procedure in which a patient's white blood cells are exposed first to a drug called 8-methoxypsoralen (8-MOP) and then to ultraviolet A (UVA) light. The procedure starts with the removal of the patient's blood, which is centrifuged to isolate the white blood cells. The drug is typically administered directly to the white blood cells after they have been removed from the patient (referred to as ex vivo administration) but the drug can alternatively be administered directly to the patient before the white blood cells are withdrawn. After UVA light exposure, the treated white blood cells are then re-infused into the patient.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

The CMS has determined that extracorporeal photopheresis is reasonable and necessary under §1862(a)(1)(A) of the Social Security Act under the following circumstances:

1. Effective April 8, 1988, Medicare provides coverage for:

- Palliative treatment of skin manifestations of CTCL that has not responded to other therapy.

2. Effective December 19, 2006, Medicare also provides coverage for:

- Patients with acute cardiac allograft rejection whose disease is refractory to standard immunosuppressive drug treatment; and
- Patients with chronic graft versus host disease whose disease is refractory to standard immunosuppressive drug treatment.

C. Nationally Noncovered Indications

All other indications for extracorporeal photopheresis remain noncovered.

D. Other

Claims processing instructions can be found in chapter 32, section 190 of the Medicare Claims Processing Manual.

(This NCD last reviewed December 2006.)

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 1206 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

[TN 2473 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

[TN 2494 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

[TN 2506 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

[TN 2543 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

[TN 2551 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

66

Revision History

04/1988 - Provided coverage when used in the palliative treatment of skin manifestations of cutaneous T-cell lymphoma that has not responded to other therapy. Effective date 04/08/1988. (TN 24)

Extracorporeal photopheresis is now covered for patients with acute cardiac allograft rejection or chronic graft versus host disease whose disease is refractory to standard immunosuppressive drug treatment. Effective date 12/19/2006 Implementation date 04/02/2007. (TN 66)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [First reconsideration for Extracorporeal Photopheresis \(CAG-00324R\)](#)
- [Second reconsideration for Extracorporeal Photopheresis \(ECP\) \(CAG-00324R2\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Extracorporeal Photopheresis	3	04/30/2012 - N/A	View
Extracorporeal Photopheresis	2	12/19/2006 - 04/30/2012	You are here
Extracorporeal Photopheresis	1	04/08/1988 - 12/19/2006	View